



• ELITE PLAN • \$34.99 CAD/MONTH

FROM BEGINNER TO
ADVANCED

TRAINING PLAN

Eight weeks in four progressive phases,
with the 30 fundamental exercises
explained **mistake by mistake**.

4 PHASES

30 EXERCISES

LOAD LOG

DELOADS INCLUDED



PROGRESSION

Load and unload

8

WEEKS

30

EXERCISES

4

PROGRESSIVE
PHASES

11

PAGES

FOUR PROGRESSIVE PHASES

Each phase builds on the one before it: technique, strength base, peak intensity and getting lean. Skipping one is the most efficient way to stall or get injured.

PHASE	WEEKS	LEVEL	VOLUME	INTENSITY	TARGET
1 · ACTIVATION	1-2	Beginner	12-16 sets/wk	60-70 % 1RM	Learn the technique and switch the patterns on
2 · DEVELOPMENT	3-4	Basic	16-20 sets/wk	65-75 % 1RM	Build a base of strength and hypertrophy
3 · INTENSIFICATION	5-6	Intermediate	20-24 sets/wk	75-85 % 1RM	Peak hypertrophy and your first personal records
4 · BURN	7-8	Advanced	18-22 sets/wk	70-80 % + HIIT	Get lean while keeping the muscle

THE THREE CONCEPTS YOU NEED TO MASTER

RIR

Reps in reserve: the ones you **could** still have done when the set ended. RIR 2 means two were left. It is the most reliable way to regulate intensity without calculating your 1RM.

PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD

Every week: more weight, more reps, or better execution at the same weight. If none of the three goes up, you are not progressing.

EFFECTIVE VOLUME

Sets per muscle group per week taken close to failure. Between 10 and 20 is the range where almost all the growth happens.

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PHASE 1 · ACTIVATION

Full body 3 days a week with the 8 basic patterns

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Push / Pull / Legs, 4 days a week

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Upper / Lower, 5 days plus intensity techniques

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THE 30 EXERCISES, ONE BY ONE

Technique, common mistake and key tip

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PHASE 1 · ACTIVATION

Full body three days a week (Monday, Wednesday and Friday) with at least one rest day between sessions. **Technique outranks weight:** perfect form prevents injury and maximises the real stimulus on the muscle.

#	EXERCISE	MUSCLE	SETS	REPS	REST	KEY TECHNIQUE
1	Barbell squat	Quads, glutes, core	3	12-15	90 s	Knees tracking over the feet, back straight
2	Flat bench press	Chest, triceps	3	12-15	90 s	Scapulae retracted, elbows at 45°
3	Barbell row	Lats, biceps	3	12-15	90 s	Torso at 45°, pull the elbow back
4	Overhead press	Shoulders, triceps	3	12-15	90 s	Core braced, no arching in the lower back
5	Romanian deadlift	Hamstrings, glutes	3	12	90 s	Hip hinge, bar grazing the legs
6	Assisted pull-ups	Lats, biceps	3	8-10	90 s	Full range, no swinging
7	Walking lunges	Quads, glutes	3	10/side	60 s	The front knee does not travel past the toes
8	Abdominal plank	Full core	3	30-45 s	60 s	Hip neutral, navel drawn in

HOW TO CHOOSE YOUR STARTING WEIGHT

01 Feeler set

Start with a weight you can move 15 times with obvious ease. That is your starting point, not your ceiling.

02 Adjust on the second set

If you still had more than four reps left at 15, add between 5 and 10 %.

03 Finish at RIR 3

In this phase you should end every set knowing three reps were left. No muscular failure.

04 Log everything from day one

Without a record there is no progression, and phase 2 starts exactly where this one ends.

THE REAL GOAL OF THESE TWO WEEKS

That the eight patterns come out automatically and pain-free. Do not chase soreness or records: aim for squat number 15 to look exactly as good as number 1.

PHASE 2 · DEVELOPMENT

You switch to a four-day Push / Pull / Legs split. Raise the weights by 5 to 10 % over phase 1. The target RIR is 2-3: **it should be hard, but you do not reach failure.**

DAY	GROUPS	EXERCISES	SETS
Monday · PUSH	Chest, shoulders, triceps	Bench press · Incline press · Flyes · Overhead press · Triceps extension · Dips	18-20
Tuesday · PULL	Back, biceps	Pull-ups · Barbell row · Lat pulldown · Face pull · Barbell curl · Hammer curl	18-20
Thursday · LEGS	Legs, glutes	Squat · Leg press · Romanian deadlift · Hip thrust · Leg extensions · Leg curl	20-22
Friday · FULL	Full body (heavy)	Heavy squat · Heavy bench press · Deadlift · Overhead press	12-16

SET AND REP SCHEME

TYPE OF EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	RIR	REST
Main compound	4	6-8	2	150 s
Secondary compound	3	8-10	2	120 s
Isolation	3	12-15	1-2	60-90 s
Core	3	15-20	2	60 s

WEEK-BY-WEEK PROGRESSION

WHERE YOU ARE AT THE END OF THE SET	WHAT YOU DO NEXT SESSION
You hit the top of the rep range at RIR 2 or more	Add 2.5-5 % to the weight and go back to the bottom of the range
You are inside the range at RIR 1-2	Repeat the same weight and chase one more rep
You cannot reach the bottom of the range	Drop the weight by 5 %: you overshot on the last increase
Two sessions in a row without progress	Check sleep, calories and protein before you touch the programme

FRIDAY IS THE MOST NEGLECTED DAY

Friday's heavy full-body session is the one that consolidates strength in the main patterns. Arrive at it fresh: if Thursday's leg day wrecks you, it means you are going to failure when you should not be.

PHASE 3 · INTENSIFICATION

Five days on an Upper / Lower structure, with strength and hypertrophy work kept separate. This is the phase where the first personal records appear. **RIR 1-2**, and only the last set of the isolation work goes to failure.

DAY	MAIN BLOCK	ACCESSORY BLOCK	SETS
Monday Upper, strength	Bench press 5×5 · Barbell row 5×5	Overhead press 3×8 · Weighted pull-ups 3×6 · Face pull 3×15	21
Tuesday Lower, strength	Squat 5×5 · Deadlift 4×4	Leg press 3×10 · Leg curl 3×12 · Calf raise 4×15	22
Wednesday	Active rest: 30 min of walking and mobility		—
Thursday Upper, hypertrophy	Incline press 4×10 · Lat pulldown 4×10	Flyes 3×12 · Lateral raises 4×15 · Curl 3×12 · Cable triceps 3×12	24
Friday Lower, hypertrophy	Bulgarian split squat 4×10 · Hip thrust 4×10	Leg extensions 3×15 · Romanian deadlift 3×12 · Calf raise 4×20	22
Saturday Weak points	Pick the two groups that respond worst and add 6-8 isolation sets		6-8

INTENSITY TECHNIQUES · ONE PER SESSION, NEVER MORE

TECHNIQUE	HOW IT IS DONE	WHERE TO USE IT
Drop set	At failure, cut the weight by 20 % and carry on with no rest	The last set of an isolation exercise
Rest-pause	At failure, rest 15 s and squeeze out 3-5 more reps	Machines or cables, never with a free barbell
Partial reps	At failure, keep going in the range where you are strongest	Lateral raises and curls
Mechanical drop sets	At failure, switch to an easier variant of the same pattern	Push-ups, pull-ups, presses

THIS IS THE PHASE THAT BREAKS THE MOST PEOPLE

Twenty-two sets per group at 85 % of 1RM only works if you eat at surplus or maintenance and sleep 8 hours. If you are in an aggressive calorie deficit, stay on phase 2 volume: you gain nothing by adding sets you cannot recover from.

PHASE 4 · BURN

Four weights sessions plus three of HIIT. Volume comes down slightly and supersets and circuits appear, to raise the density of the training. **The main loads do not drop:** that is what preserves muscle in a deficit.

DAY	CONTENTS	SETS	FORMAT
Monday · Upper	Bench press 4×6 · Row 4×6 · Superset: overhead press + pulldown 3×10 · Superset: curl + triceps 3×12	20	Strength + supersets
Tuesday · HIIT	Intervals of 40 s all-out / 20 s walking, 24 min in total	—	Intervals
Wednesday · Lower	Squat 4×6 · Romanian deadlift 4×8 · Superset: leg press + leg curl 3×12 · Calf raise 4×20	22	Strength + supersets
Thursday · HIIT	Core circuit, 30 s of work / 10 s of rest, 6 circuits (18 min)	—	Intervals
Friday · Upper	Incline press 4×10 · Pull-ups 4×max · Shoulder and arm circuit, 3 rounds	18	Hypertrophy + circuit
Saturday · Lower	Hip thrust 4×10 · Lunges 3×12 · Leg extensions 3×15 · Core circuit, 3 rounds	19	Hypertrophy + circuit
Sunday · HIIT	Full-body circuit, 30 s / 15 s, 5 rounds (25 min), or complete rest	—	Optional

HOW SUPERSETS AND CIRCUITS ARE RUN

FORMAT	EXECUTION	REST	ADVANTAGE
Antagonist superset	Two exercises for opposing groups, with no rest between them	90 s after the pair	Saves time without losing performance
Circuit	3-4 exercises back to back, 12-15 reps each	2 min between rounds	High density and calorie burn
Compound set	Two exercises for the same group, back to back	2 min	Maximum local fatigue — use it on isolation work only

RULES FOR THE CUTTING PHASE

- **Never drop the weight in order to do more reps.** Muscle is preserved by load, not by the burning sensation.
- Do not do HIIT the day before leg day, nor the day after.
- If you lose more than 10 % on your bench press, you have a recovery problem: raise calories or drop one HIIT session.
- Week 8 ends with a deload: cut the volume by 40 % and keep the load.

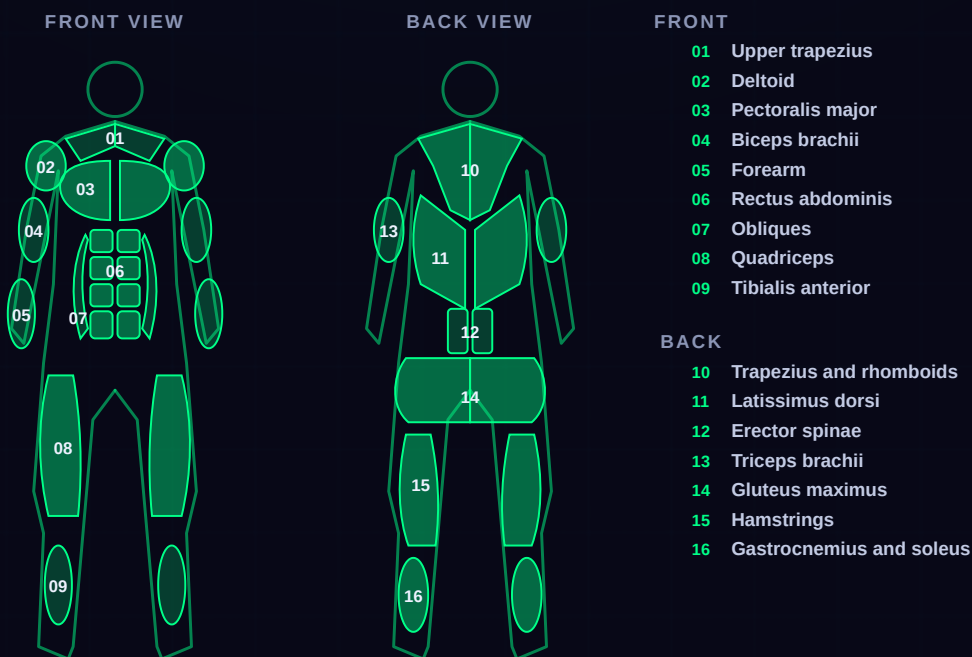
WHEN THE 8 WEEKS ARE OVER

Take a full week of deload and start again from phase 2 with your new loads. The cycle works indefinitely: each pass starts from a higher level.

REFERENCE MUSCLE MAP

These are the sixteen groups the plan covers. Before you close your week, check that **none of them is left without a stimulus**: it is the most common programming mistake, and the one that produces the imbalances that later take years to correct.

FIG. 1 THE SIXTEEN GROUPS IN THE PLAN



Front and back views, with the numbering used in the tables on the following pages.

MINIMUM WEEKLY COVERAGE

GROUP	SETS/WEEK	EXERCISES IN THE PLAN THAT COVER IT
Chest (03)	10–20	Bench press, incline press, flyes, dips
Back (10, 11)	12–22	Pull-ups, barbell row, pulldown, cable row
Legs (08, 15, 16)	14–24	Squat, Romanian deadlift, leg press, leg curl
Glutes (14)	8–16	Hip thrust, Bulgarian split squat, lunges
Shoulders (02)	8–16	Overhead press, lateral raises, face pull
Arms (04, 13)	6–14	Curl, hammer curl, triceps extension, dips
Core (06, 07, 12)	6–12	Plank, cable crunch, deadlift (indirect)

THE GROUPS ALMOST EVERYONE NEGLECTS

The **rear deltoid (02)**, the **hamstrings (15)** and the **calves (16)**. All three are trained in the plan, but they are the first thing people skip when they are in a hurry — and all three do the most to balance a physique and protect the joint.

THE 30 EXERCISES · PART 1

#	EXERCISE	MUSCLE GROUP	LEVEL	COMMON MISTAKE	KEY TIP
1	Barbell squat	Quads, glutes, core	B	Knees caving inwards	Push the floor away with the whole foot
2	Bench press	Chest, triceps	B	Elbows flared right out to 90°	Scapulae locked against the bench
3	Conventional deadlift	Back, legs	A	Rounding the lower back	Bar against the leg through the whole lift
4	Pull-ups	Lats, biceps	I	Swinging the body	Think about driving the elbows to your back pocket
5	Barbell row	Mid-back	I	Torso too upright	Hold 45° and do not drive with the lower back
6	Overhead press	Shoulder	B	Over-arching the lower back	Squeeze glutes and abs before you press
7	Hip thrust	Glutes	B	Not reaching full extension	1 s pause at the top with the pelvis tucked
8	Leg press	Quadriceps	B	Knees collapsing inwards	Do not let your lower back come off the pad
9	Parallel-bar dips	Triceps, chest	I	Leaning the torso too far forward	Upright for triceps, leaning for chest
10	Barbell curl	Biceps	B	Letting the elbow drift forward	Elbows pinned to your sides, no swinging
11	Incline press	Upper chest	I	Bringing the bar down too low	30° of incline; more adds nothing
12	Cable row	Lats	B	Pulling with the lower back	Chest up and torso still
13	Lateral raises	Lateral deltoid	B	Shrugging the shoulders on the way up	Raise only to shoulder height
14	Cable triceps extension	Triceps	B	Letting the elbows drift away from your sides	Only the forearm moves
15	Cable curl	Biceps	B	Swinging the torso	Lean against a wall if you cannot avoid it

B Basic · I Intermediate · A Advanced

THE 30 EXERCISES · PART 2

#	EXERCISE	MUSCLE GROUP	LEVEL	COMMON MISTAKE	KEY TIP
16	Dumbbell lunges	Quads, glutes	B	The front knee caves inwards	Long step for glutes, short step for quads
17	Romanian deadlift	Hamstrings, glutes	I	Bending the knees too much	Send the hip back; do not simply lower the torso
18	Pec deck flyes	Inner chest	B	Letting the chest flatten at the end	Keep the chest up and squeeze for 1 s
19	Lying leg curl	Hamstrings	B	Lifting the hips off the bench	Lower the weight if you have to lift the hip
20	Dumbbell shoulder press	Shoulder	B	Not locking out at the top	Wrists stacked over the elbows throughout
21	Cable crossover	Chest	I	Straightening the elbows too much	Elbows slightly bent and fixed
22	Lat pulldown	Lats	B	Leaning the torso too far back	20° of lean at most
23	Leg extension	Quadriceps	B	Lifting too fast	2 s of controlled lowering on every rep
24	Reverse fly	Rear deltoid	B	Moving the elbows during the rep	Light weight: ego is worth nothing here
25	Hammer curl	Brachialis, biceps	B	Supinating the wrist on the way up	Strict neutral grip from start to finish
26	Face pull	Traps, rear shoulder	B	Pulling from too low a height	Cable at face height, elbows high
27	Plank	Core	B	Hip too high or sagging	30 perfect seconds beat 2 badly held minutes
28	Cable crunch	Abs	I	Pulling on your neck with your hands	Flex the spine, not the hip
29	Bulgarian split squat	Quads, glutes	A	Front knee too far forward	Set the foot well away from the bench and find your balance first
30	Weighted pull-ups	Lats, biceps	A	Partial range of motion	Only add weight once you can do 10 clean reps unloaded

IF AN EXERCISE HURTS, REPLACE IT

Every pattern has alternatives: squat → leg press or goblet squat; bench press → dumbbell press; deadlift → dumbbell Romanian deadlift. **You do not train through joint pain, you work around it.**

WHAT SURROUNDS THE SETS

STANDARD WARM-UP · 8 MINUTES

MINUTE	CONTENTS	WHY
0-3	Easy cardio: bike, rower or treadmill	Raises temperature and heart rate
3-5	Mobility for the joint of the day	Hip and ankle, or shoulder and thoracic spine
5-8	Ramp-up sets at 40 %, 60 % and 80 %	Primes the nervous system

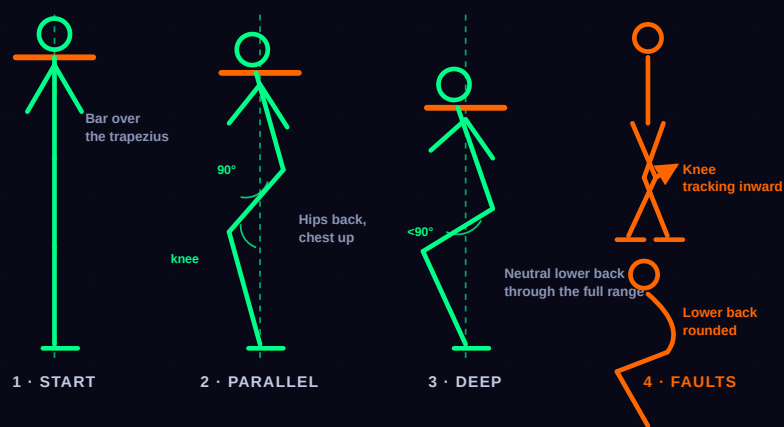
THE RIR SCALE

RIR	HOW IT FEELS	WHEN TO USE IT
4-5	Comfortable, flawless technique	Ramp-up sets and deloads
3	Demanding but controlled	Phase 1
2	The bar starts slowing down	Phases 2 and 3
1	The last rep is a real grind	Compound lifts in phase 3
0	Muscular failure	Isolation work only

WHEN A DELOAD IS NEEDED

- ☐ Two weeks without progress on any main lift
- ☐ Persistent joint pain during the warm-up
- ☐ It has been 6-8 weeks since the last one

FIG. 2 THE SQUAT: THE CORRECT PATH AND THE TWO EXPENSIVE MISTAKES



The dotted line is the **plumb line**: the bar must always fall over the middle of the foot. The two mistakes on the right are what cause most knee and lower-back injuries.

STRETCHING: WHEN YES AND WHEN NO

Static stretching **after** training, not before: it reduces force production. Before, do dynamic mobility.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

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WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

YOUR PROGRESSION LOG

EXERCISE	WK 1	WK 2	WK 3	WK 4	WK 5	WK 6	WK 7	WK 8
Squat								
Bench press								
Deadlift								
Overhead press								
Barbell row								
Pull-ups								
Hip thrust								

PERSONAL RECORDS FOR THE CYCLE

EXERCISE	STARTING MARK	FINAL MARK	IMPROVEMENT	DATE

EIGHT WEEKS, ONE SINGLE RULE

Progression only works if you **write down every set**: without a log there is no overload, there is repetition. Eight weeks properly recorded are worth more than a year of training from memory.

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